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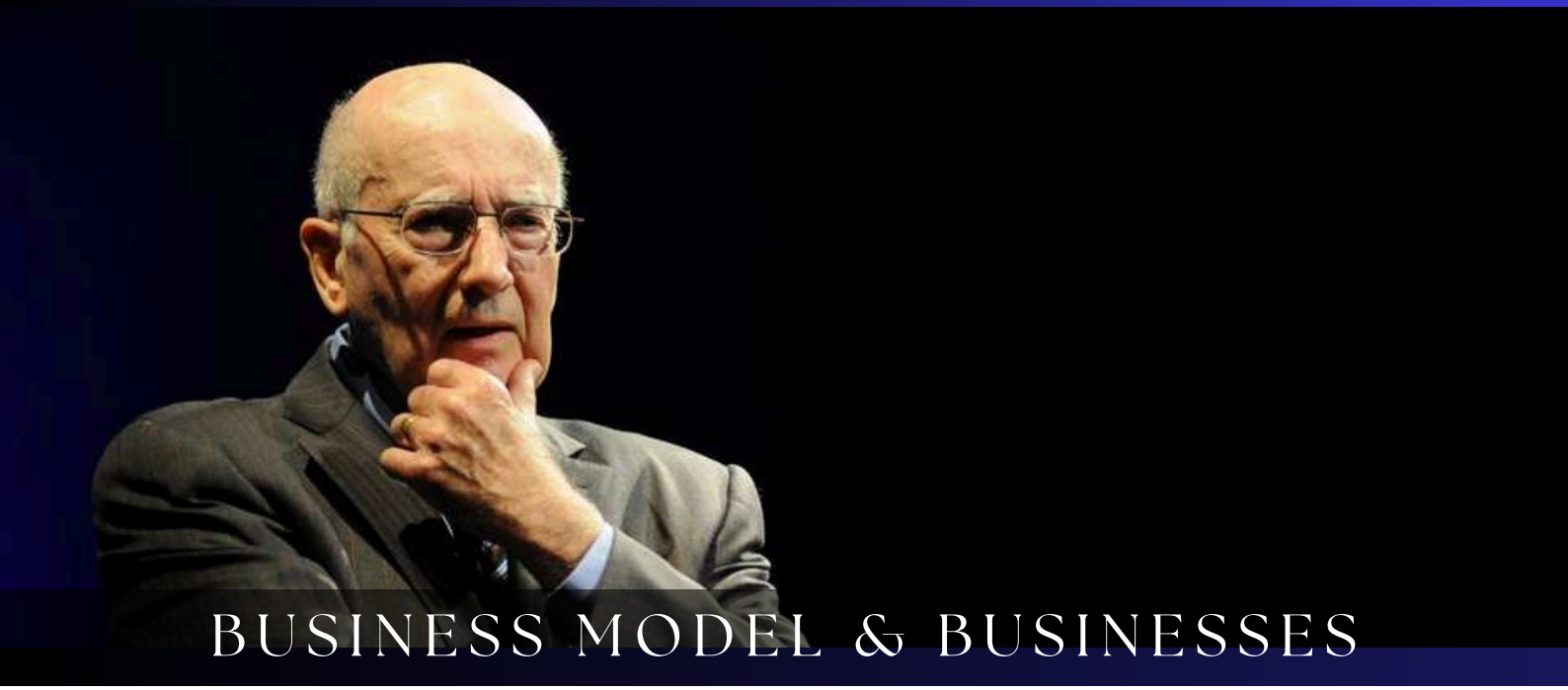
Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

VENTURES VOYAGE

BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM



BUSINESS MODEL & BUSINESSES

PORTER

Uber

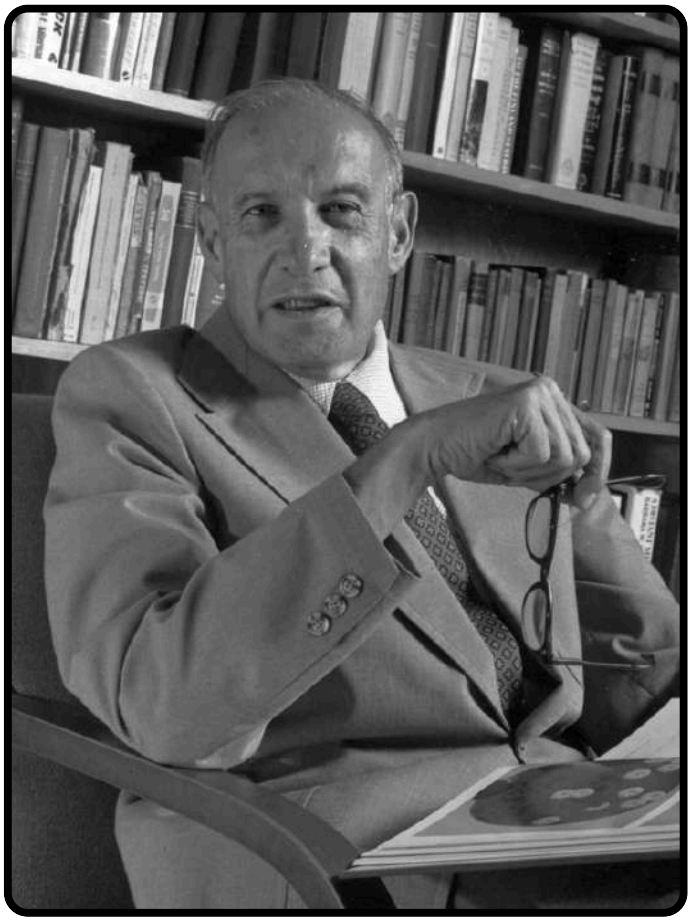
MARCH-2025

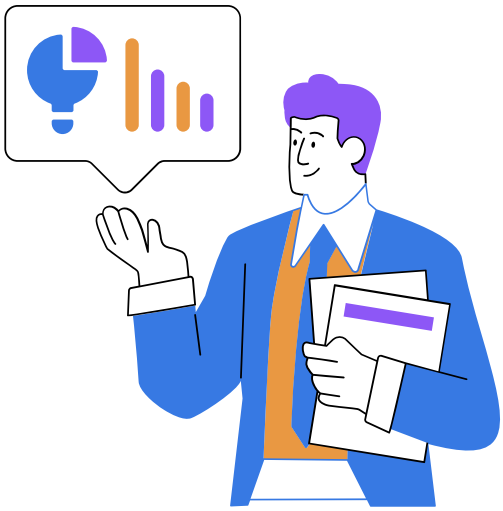
INTRODUCTION

"The best way to predict the future is to create it." – Peter Drucker

In the modern era of fast-paced and competitive business environment, the key to long-term success is not necessarily possessing a great product or service but possessing the right business model. A well-designed business model can redefine customer experiences, streamline operations, and build lasting top-line growth. Businesses that innovate their models often find themselves outperforming competitors and reshaping entire industries.
Take Apple, for instance. By combining a product-based model with an ecosystem approach, Apple has built a loyal customer base while generating continuous revenue through hardware sales and digital services.

In this edition, we look at how innovative business models lead to success and take a lesson from the real-life examples of businesses that have succeeded through out-of-the-box thinking. Whether you are an aspiring entrepreneur or a seasoned business leader, knowing and implementing the right model can be a game-changer. Let us take you through the strategies that enable businesses not just to survive but to lead and dominate the marketplace today.





Written By:
Sushmita Poojari
MBA - Finance

"THE TRUTH ABOUT HP PRINTERS: IT'S NOT THE PRINTER, IT'S THE INK"

The Razor and Blade Business Model is a clever profit strategy that HP has utilized to generate revenue even during times of loss. Have you noticed how some items are sold at low prices, while their refills or replacements are priced high? This phenomenon is known as the razor and blade model. Companies offer the primary product at a low cost or even at a loss and profit from selling expensive refills. King Camp Gillette, the founder of Gillette razors, popularized this approach in the early 1900s by providing inexpensive razor handles while charging a premium for replacement blades. This model continues to be a significant source of profit for Gillette today.
A major challenge with this model is the threat of competition. If other brands offer cheaper refills, the original brand may suffer a loss of profits. To counter this, companies create exclusive designs that ensure only their refills are compatible.

HP applies the Razor and Blades business model by crafting its printers to function only with HP ink cartridges. Just as razor companies design unique blades to maintain exclusivity, HP ensures that its printers are designed specifically for proprietary ink, thus securing ongoing income from cartridge sales.

Affordable Printers – HP markets printers at low prices, occasionally even at a loss.

High-Priced Ink – HP generates profit by selling high-cost ink cartridges.

Preventing Cheaper Ink – HP employs smart chips and software to block third-party inks.

Subscription Option – HP's Instant Ink service guarantees consistent revenue. Even if HP incurs losses on printer sales, it maintains steady earnings through ink sales, similar to how Gillette profits from razor blades.

Written By:
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From Stores to Screens: The Rise of the Bricks-and-Clicks Model

A corporation's well-crafted business model is the inspiration for its successfulness, healthy growth, profitability and competitive facet.The clicks-and-mortar enterprise model is a mixture of bricks bodily sales and clicks internet sales that employs a hybrid retail technique in supplying a seamless shopping for buyers.

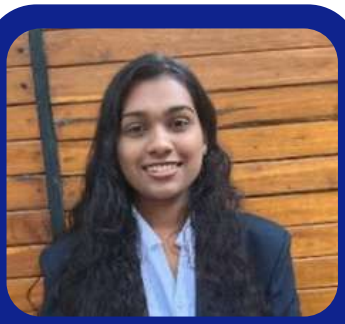
Decathlon a global's biggest sports activities retailer has applied The bricks-and-clicks business model to gain market competitiveness ahead of rivals. They rationalized large bodily shops together with a sturdy online platform, allowing decathlon to enhance client satisfaction, rationalize inventory ,manage and boost income turnover. Decathlon stores ie the big ones had been get-together locations wherein buyers can check and snap up items with assistance from a personnel member.

As e-trade speeded up the commercial enterprise it merged conventional shopping with on line purchasing . Buyers have the ability to make use of the press and gather approach permitting clients to purchase products affirm inventory tiers and prefer to choose up the goods in store or get them shipped to their residence .

Decathlon has a fantastic stock management, their stores are local supply points that helps in faster shipping and lower-price transport operations. Moreover the organization reschedules stock amongst stores and also does supply degree optimization with the help of data analytics and AI .

Decathlon additionally improves online buying by means of supplying digital product fitting AI exhortation and a patron of loyalty cellular software. This approach ensures that clients are acquainted with the first-class buying experience inadvertent of shopping online or in store

With a hit mixture of physical and on-line retailing decathlon has come one of the top gamers inside the sports quarter for modern clients who treasure comfort and affordability.



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WHY WALMART OUTPERFORMS: THE POWER OF COST EFFICIENCY AND SMART LOGISTICS

The **Walmart business** model thrives upon principles of Everyday Low Prices (EDLP) and an extraordinarily efficient supply chain. The EDLP strategy guarantees that customers are able to purchase products at prices that are below those offered by competing stores without having to wait for special sales or discounts. The establishment of trust by this approach results in stores and the Companies receiving continued traffic from customers.

To keep prices low is a highly streamlined and efficient supply chain. Walmart invests a lot of money into technology and logistics, using advanced data analytics and automation to manage inventories, forecast demand, and optimize distribution. The distribution centers are recognizable, well-located within easy reach of key markets, prevent heavy transport costs and speed the delivery of goods.

Walmart
Save money. Live better.

Walmart also relies on firm partnerships with suppliers, often negotiating bulk purchasing arrangements aimed at cost minimization. Its private label brands, such as Great Value, allow for a reduction in pricing through eliminating some intermediary costs.

And this unique mix of low pricing and supply chain management efficiency has enabled Walmart to stand really tall in the global retailing arena. In summary, Walmart, by integrating EDLP with an efficient supply chain, is able to carry out high-volume sales with low-profit margins; thin profits are compensated through sheer scale. This model strengthens cost whittle and maximizes customer satisfaction, thus retaining Walmart's position as a global retail champion.

Written By:
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THE SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP MODEL

When we think of doing business, one thing will come to mind: profits. Despite this, some companies are choosing the Social Entrepreneurship Model with their innovative approach. It's an amalgamation of purpose and profit by exhibiting that doing good and doing well can be jointly beneficial, that leads to a positive ripple effect.

The foreign brand, Patagonia India's approach has inspired indigenous brands like “Goonj”, an innovator in Social Entrepreneurship. Goonj doesn't merely sell products but it sells a vision. It addresses the needs of rural India like sanitary pads, school supplies, clothing, etc. by converting urban waste into reusable resources, which also supports local people. They involve customers in a bigger movement with their initiative of "Cloth for Work" to ensure that every item bought contributes to sustainable development.

One beautiful example of innovation from the grassroots is “Barefoot College”. To become solar engineers, this organisation, which is located in Rajasthan, grooms rural women and often grandmothers. These women are improving lives while earning a living by bringing electricity to their villages. It's an innovative thinking that empowers, educates and electrifies in reality as well as symbolically.

TATA Group has mastered the social entrepreneurship business model with initiatives like Tata Trusts, which targets healthcare, education, and rural development. The projects, like the Cancer Care Hospital, show how a business can act as a change agent despite being profitable.

These enterprises are not merely businesses but they are movements. They exhibit that success is more than simply the bottom line - it is about uplifting others as you climb. They provide a path for Budding Entrepreneurs to create with purpose, and the money will follow you. In India, Social Entrepreneurship is simply more than just a business model because its purpose is clear: “Do well by doing good.”

Written By:
Krishna Gutte
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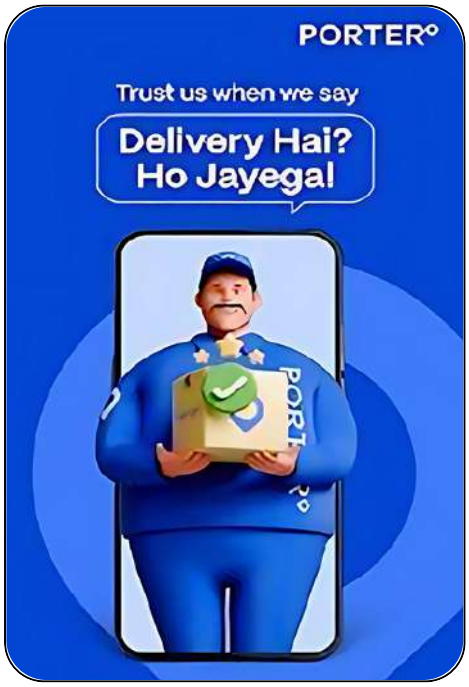
Porter and the Power of On-Demand Logistics in India

Porter is an Indian logistics platform offering instant service without the need for owning vehicles. Rather, it collaborates with drivers who opt to join the platform as service providers. Clients can book a vehicle via the Porter app whenever they require it, just like individuals book cabs on ride-hailing apps. Such a business model is called an On-Demand business model where products or services are provided to customers whenever they are required.



Porter's disrupted local logistics by providing immediate access to trucks, tempos, and bikes. Contrary to other logistics providers, Porter is asset-light, or it does not own vehicles but instead links customers with driver-partners. This lowers the operational cost and facilitates quick growth.

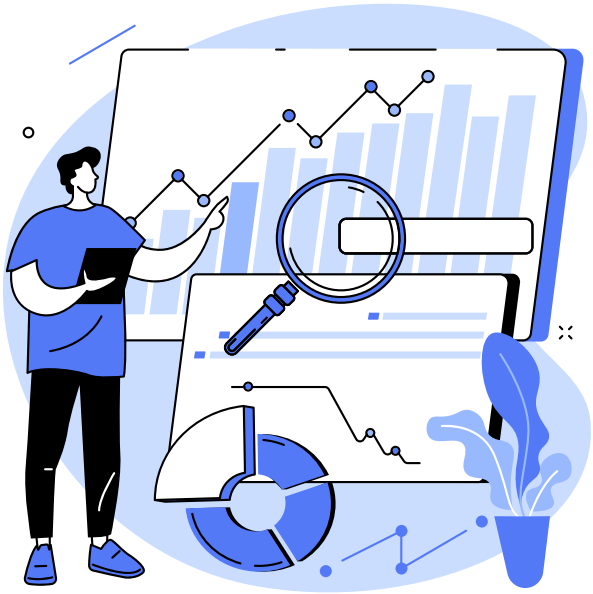
The platform also provides an affordable service by cutting out middlemen, resulting in improved prices for customers. A large network of drivers ensures quicker deliveries and high service reliability, making it a business and individual favorite. Flexibility in earnings is a major benefit for drivers, as they can work at their convenience and earn the most.

Porter's on-demand business model has transformed urban logistics in India with value-for-money, reliable, and technology-enabled transportation solutions, establishing it as a reliable choice for businesses, individuals, and driver-partners equally.

Written By:
Varad Mulgund
MBA - BA

HYBRID BUSINESS MODELS: A SMART STRATEGY FOR EXPANSION

With the fast-changing market of the present times, most companies utilize hybrid business models to increase their revenue and clientele. A Hybrid Business Model is an approach in which an organization blends two or more business models to optimize revenue, extend market reach, and enhance customer experience.

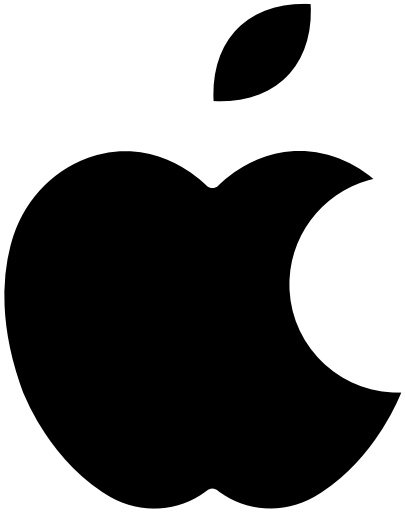


One such great example is that of Amazon, which operates on three models' side by side. It works as a market where sellers may put up goods and sell them. It operates as a subscription service under the heading of Amazon Prime, wherein clients pay to have their items delivered faster as well as receive extras like Prime Video.

It makes money in addition through advertising, whereby the sellers remunerate money for advertising products on the site.

Apple is another company with a hybrid model. It is a manufacturer, making iPhones, iPads, and MacBooks. It also has a retail model, marketing the products both through stores and online. Apple uses a subscription model through platforms like iCloud, Apple Music, and Apple TV+. This is a combination that works for Apple in terms of generating revenue both from hardware as well as from digital services.

Hybrid business models allow companies to maximize profits, reach different segments of customers, and react to market trends. By combining the most effective approaches, organizations can outsmart competitors and develop effectively.



amazon

Written By:
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BEYOND RELIANCE - UNLEASHING BUSINESS MODEL FOR COMPETITIVE DOMINANCE

Reliance Ltd. has employed a diverse business model in multiple sectors. The strategies opted by the company encourage them to sustain in the business model. The key elements of Reliance's Business Model – Initially, have customer segments which include End Users and Businesses; the value proposition of the company includes quality products and sustainability, followed by revenue streams including product sales, services, and licensing and royalties.

The asset-light business model was equipped with analyzing the cost deduction with the handling of operational functions. In terms of sales and marketing, Reliance opted for a Hybrid business model as Reliance fresh stores offer a blend of online delivery and in-store shopping services, catering to diverse customers.

In the petrochemical sector, the company followed vertical integration with connected various levels of supply chain management from the raw materials to the finished products, for seamless logistic functions.

These models have upgraded the standard by enhancing the functionality of the production.

Written By:
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CONCLUSION

In conclusion, businesses that outperform today are those that can adapt, innovate, and stay deeply focused on their customers. Whether shifting to subscription models, creating integrated digital ecosystems, or optimizing supply chains, these companies have found ways to stay ahead by being agile and forward-thinking.

Some have moved beyond just selling products, offering services or experiences that keep customers coming back, while others diversify across different sectors to reduce risk and uncover new growth opportunities. At the same time, many out-performing businesses recognize the importance of sustainability & social responsibility, which not only boosts their brand but also strengthens customer loyalty.

What sets these companies apart is their ability to continuously innovate while keeping customers at the heart of their strategy. They balance operational excellence with a genuine commitment to making a positive impact, ensuring long-term success. In the end, the key to their performance lies in their ability to evolve with the times, building lasting value for both their customers and the world around them.

Written By:

Vedashree Ghotkar
FY MBA HR

SUCCESS STORIES

Businesses leverage their eccentric strategies to outperform their competitors. Here are theprime examples of successful business models:

1. SUBSCRIPTION MODEL : NETFLIX

Netflix with its subscription model provided continuous revenue and predictable customer retention. Initially, Netflix was a DVD rental company which transitioned into streaming services and original content, successfully pivoting itself into the subscription model. Netflix was one of the first companies to enter this sector and is now a giant company in the subscription-based business model.

2. FREEMIUM MODEL: SPOTIFY

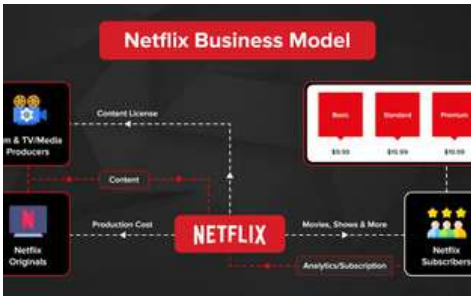
Spotify offers fa ree music streaming service while providing ads. Its premium subscription has an ad-free version for music streaming. This model attracts a large user base and eventually converts a portion of its users into paying subscribers. Spotify provides personalized playlists which keep their users engaged.

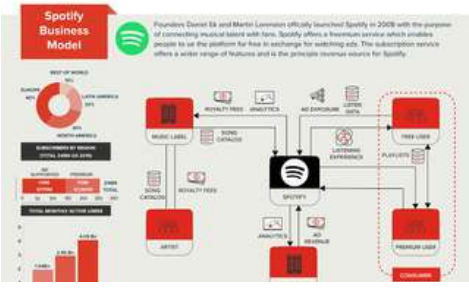
3. ON DEMAND MODEL: UBER

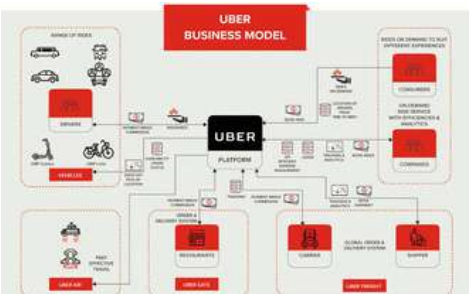
Uber disrupted the transportation sector by introducing an on-demand model that connected riders with drivers directly via a mobile app. Uber became a household name by utilizing dynamic pricing and cashless transactions. Uber became a global player in the on-demand services business model.

4. MARKETPLACE MODEL: AMAZON

Amazon led its way to global domination in the market sector by providing a platform to the traditional retail market. It gave access to third-party sellers to reach its customers worldwide. By leveraging logistics, personalized recommendations, and amazon prime services like one day delivery, hit helped create Amazon a massive ecosystem that has kept the customers engaged.







Written By:
Sanjana Kashyap
MBA - HR

SUGGESTION BOX

BOOKS:

IIMA - Day to Day Economics by Satish Y. Deodhar – Explains economic concepts with real-life Indian business examples.

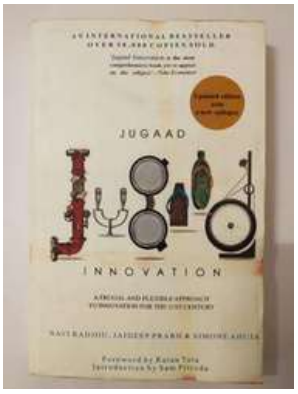
Jugaad Innovation by Navi Radjou – Explores frugal innovation strategies widely used in Indian businesses.

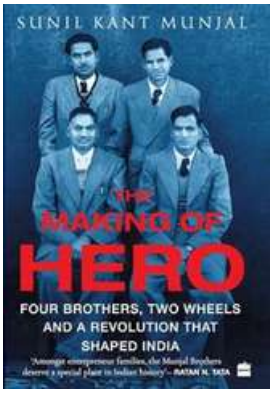
The Making of Hero by Sunil Kant Munjal – Chronicles Hero MotoCorp's journey and innovative business model.

Stay Hungry Stay Foolish by Rashmi Bansal – Features 25 IIM Ahmedabad graduates who turned entrepreneurs.

COURSES:

- Startup India Learning Program (by Invest India) – A free course for Indian entrepreneurs on business models, funding, and growth strategies.
- IIM Bangalore's 'Entrepreneurship: Essential Business Model' – Focuses on designing scalable business models for Indian markets.
- Coursera's 'Innovation and Startup Strategy' by ISB (Indian School of Business) – Offers insights on building sustainable startups in India.





Written By:
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WHAT'S HAPPENING IN THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD?

As the entrepreneurial world becomes more connected, major startup and investment events have become essential hubs where fast-growing businesses, investors, and corporations come together. These events offer a chance to uncover new opportunities, build strategic partnerships, and stay ahead of the latest market trends in an ever-evolving landscape.

AI Action Summit | Date: February 10th - 11th, 2025 | Location: Grand Palais, Paris, France

The AI Action Summit was held at the Grand Palais in Paris, co-chaired by French President Emmanuel Macron and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The event brought together over 1,000 participants from more than 100 countries, focusing on leveraging artificial intelligence for economic growth. During the summit, the European Union introduced InvestAI, a €200 billion initiative to develop AI gigafactories and strengthen AI infrastructure. Additionally, private investors committed nearly €110 billion to support France's AI sector, highlighting Europe's dedication to leading AI innovation.

World Entrepreneur Summit 2025 | Date: February 12th – 13th, 2025 | Location:Dubai, United Arab Emirates

The World Entrepreneur Summit 2025 in Dubai brought together over 5,000 entrepreneurs from more than 120 countries. Key moments included the launch of the $10 billion Global Innovation Fund to support AI, clean energy, and blockchain startups, as well as the $1 billion EmpowerHer Fund dedicated to women entrepreneurs. Renowned speakers like Elon Musk and Satya Nadella highlighted the importance of AI, cloud computing, and sustainability.

WORLD ENTREPRENEUR SUMMIT 2025

Invest Kerala Global Summit 2025 | Date: February 21st – 22nd, 2025 | Location: Kochi, Kerala, India

The Invest Kerala Global Summit 2025 served as a landmark event for the state's economic aspirations, drawing over 3,000 delegates, including investors, industry leaders, and policymakers. The summit highlighted Kerala's potential as a top investment destination, resulting in investment proposals worth approximately ₹1.53 lakh crore across diverse sectors such as aerospace, defence, biotechnology, and information technology. Additionally, the state government introduced a series of investor-friendly policies designed to streamline regulatory processes and facilitate smoother execution of investment projects, reinforcing Kerala's strategic vision for enhancing its industrial and technological landscape.

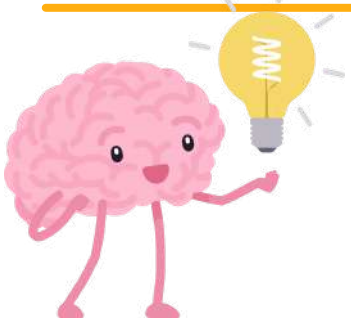
INVEST KERALA GLOBAL SUMMIT FEB 21-22, 2025 | KOCHI

Fintech Mexico Festival (Mexico City, Mexico) | Date: 27th February 2025 | Location: Papalote Museo del Niño, Mexico City.

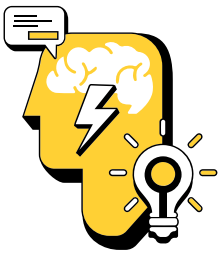
The Fintech Mexico Festival brought together financial sector leaders, regulators, and entrepreneurs to discuss the trends reshaping financial services—from digital banking to cryptocurrencies and financial inclusion. The festival featured over 70 speakers across four stages and hosted more than 25 conferences, covering the latest developments in digital payments, open banking, cryptocurrencies, artificial intelligence in finance, and more. The event welcomed over 2,000 attendees, including experts, investors, and entrepreneurs.

2025 FinTech México Festival

Written By:
YASH MUTHA
Finance- E



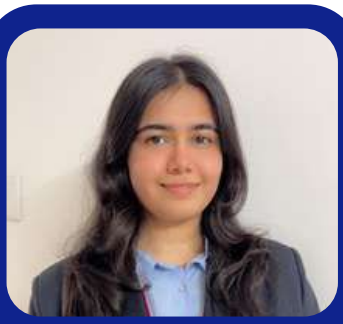
RIDDLES



1. I let people share things like cars or homes, but I'm not a rental shop. What am I?
2. I help small business grow online, but I'm not a bank. What am I?
3. I charge you every month for access, but I'm not gym. What am I?
4. I turn old things into new product, but I'm not a recycling bin. What am I?
5. I sell directly to customer, cutting out the middleman. What business type am I?
6. I hire people for short jobs, but I'm not a temp agency. What am I?
7. I sell fun and memories, not physical items, but I'm not a concert. What am I?
8. I use data to guess what you'll want next, but I'm not a fortune teller. What am I?
9. I work with others to grow my business, but I'm not a team. What am I?
10. I let you try before you buy, but I'm not a free sample. What am I?

ANSWERS

10. Freemium Model
9. Partnership Model
8. Predictive Analytics Model
7. Experience Economy Model
6. Gig Economy Model
5. Direct to consumer business
4. Circular Economy Model
3. Subscription Model
2. E-commerce Model
1. Sharing Economy Model



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